

MITEL AND AVIENTEK FORGE DISTRIBUTION PARTNERSHIP IN INDIA



Mr Shrinivas
Timmanagoudar



Mr Asif Khan



Mr VM Manu

Dubai-based leading value-added distributor of audio-visual (AV) & unified communications, Avientek recently partnered with global business communications leader Mitel, to distribute its various products and applications in India. As a Canada-based, 1973-born company, Mitel connects businesses and service providers, collaborates and communicates innovatively with their customers. Avientek is a leading value added distributor of Audio Visual & Unified Communication products and services in the Middle East, Africa and Indian Subcontinent.

Giving effect to the new collaboration, Avientek hosted 4-city roadshows in association with Mitel. Senior management from both the partner companies was present at the events held in Bangalore, Chennai, New Delhi and Mumbai in the 4th week of February 2023. Various industry dignitaries also graced the symposium with their presence.

At the events, Mitel showcased its vast product and solution range and the partners briefed the gathering about their globally-available services. Professionals from both companies presented their solutions to the gathering, which was followed by a Q&A session. Both parties were utterly optimistic about the collaboration.

In addition to the welcome note delivered by Avientek's Regional Sales Managers, Pankaj Sinha in Delhi, Dhiraj Patil in Mumbai, and Rajaram in Chennai, the company's country head, Shrinivas Timmanagoudar introduced Avientek. Mitel's Channel Director for the Middle East & Africa, Mr Asif Khan put forward the insights, Go To Market strategy and the extensive partner program for India. Afterwards, the senior channel account manager of Mitel, Mr Nooruddin Siddiqui provided a solution overview and demo to the attendees of the symposium.

I got an opportunity to chat with Mr Asif Khan, Avientek's Director, Mr VM Manu and Avientek country head Mr. Shrinivas Timmanagoudar and learnt more about the new alliance, its extent, its intent and its after-effects. In addition, the future course of action of both companies was extensively discussed. Here's an excerpt:

Q. Why did you choose to partner with Avientek?

ASIF KHAN. When we started the Indian operations, we were looking for a very strategic partnership in distribution. So, the first objective was to identify the right distribution partner who is available on the ground, and who can add value to our global perspective.

As a part of Mitel's global policy, a partner with a good understanding of the channel model, pre-sales support, operations and logistics efficiency, and credit and financing was needed. They must also have good sales so that they can work as an advisor.

We looked at many potential distribution companies in India and analysed their model and the value proposition they offer to

channel partners. We did it because, ultimately, the distribution is going to represent the vendor i.e., Mitel in India. We found that Avientek has all the ingredients that we were looking for and it can drive the regional strategy with a global mindset.

Q. Mr Manu, same question for you, why'd Avientek choose to sign this deal with Mitel?

VM MANU. Avientek is a well-known name in the distribution industry, mostly in the audio-visual and extended segments. We have partnered with a large number of companies across the region. In recent years, the differentiation between audio-video, telecom and IT is getting blurred and is becoming a single platform.

On the other side, Mitel is a global leader in business communication with a stronghold in call centres. It is well-known that India is a preferred location for a back office for a number of industries. So, since a large number of call centres are running here already, and many people are working in hybrid mode, especially after COVID, it gave us the impression that a strong communication platform is needed, with unified communication, call centres, and collaboration altogether. As Mitel is one of the world's strongest players in that segment, we chose Mitel. I'm sure that the partnership would be a great success in the market.

Q. What is the exact geographical parameter of this agreement?

VM. Right now, we have signed the deal with a pan-India mindset. To support that, we have our sales team across the region, covering almost the whole of India geographically. We have our team working in Delhi, Calcutta and Chennai. We also have our office and experience centre in Mumbai and Bangalore.

Our primary focus will be on the telecom industry. At the same time, we are focusing on good audio-visual companies so as to bring them to our side of the telecommunication and collaboration segment.

Q. Mr Asif, you have hired teams in Bangalore, Mumbai and Kolkata, but not in the North of India. Any specific reason for that?

AK. We look at the entire Indian market as one but we had planned two phases, wherein we'd have gone for two headcounts in each phase. But luckily, we got three people, and we went forward with that strategy. Of course, we have realized that the south has got a lot more addressable markets like Chennai, Hyderabad, and Bangalore. Then, Kolkata has a lot of government work, especially in the railway sector.

Nonetheless, Avientek and Mitel have decided to split the resources. Wherever Mitel's resources are present, Avientek will work with its local team. But, if Mitel's resources are not there, Avientek will come out with a complete, dedicated team. So, Mr Pankaj from Avientek is a resource for Mitel for North India. But yes, gradually, we will build a bigger team also.